Fire Emblem: Fortune's Weave Will Get New Stories and Characters

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Fans of the video game Fire Emblem: Fortune's Weave have new content to look forward to. Nintendo and the game **studio** Intelligent Systems surprised players earlier this week by announcing an **expansion pass** for the game.

Fortune's Weave came out in September 2026 and has sold well and earned praise from **critics**, according to the gaming website Polygon. The **expansion pass**, which is available now on the Nintendo eShop, will add extra content in three waves.

The first wave adds four new weapons. The game calls them Prototypes, and they are based on special weapons from an earlier game in the series, Fire Emblem: Three Houses.

The second wave is expected during the 2026 holiday season. It will give four characters called Flame Lords new outfits, which players can switch back to the originals at any time. Other characters on a player's team can wear the outfits too. This wave will also let players use three powerful characters, the Dagdan gods Aurora, Smyrnos and Jurah, in the game's third part.

The third wave is the one many fans are most excited about. It will add four new story paths, called **routes**, about four rival lords named Anatolia, Talimun, Orchel and Bertrand. It is expected in 2027.

These **routes** connect to a change that some fans did not like. In an online question-and-answer session, Intelligent Systems said the game first had eight main characters, but the team cut it to four because that seemed too **ambitious**. Fans have been asking for the missing **routes** ever since the game came out.

Polygon suggested fan requests may have played a part, but said the **routes** were likely already being made and simply needed more time.

Word Treasure

expansion pass -- An expansion pass is a purchase that unlocks extra content added to a video game over time.

studio -- A game studio is a company that designs and builds video games.

routes -- In a story game, routes are different story paths a player can follow.

ambitious -- Ambitious means trying to do something very big or difficult.

critics -- Critics are people whose job is to review and judge games, movies or books.

Background you need

Fire Emblem is a long-running series of strategy video games made by the studio Intelligent Systems and published by Nintendo.

In these games, players move a team of characters across a battlefield map, taking turns like in a board game such as chess.

Many modern video games get extra content after release, often sold together as an expansion pass.

Fortune's Weave lets players follow different story routes, and the team cut its planned main characters from eight to four before release.

Break it down

LEAD: Nintendo and Intelligent Systems surprise players with an expansion pass for Fire Emblem: Fortune's Weave.

KEY EVENT: Extra content arrives in three waves

- +- WAVE 1: Four new weapons based on Fire Emblem: Three Houses (available now)
- +- WAVE 2: New outfits and three Dagdan gods as playable characters (2026 holiday season)
- +- WAVE 3: Four new routes about rival lords (expected 2027)

BACKGROUND: The studio cut the game's main characters from eight to four, which some fans did not like

ANALYSIS: Polygon says fan requests may have helped, but the routes were likely already in progress

OPEN QUESTION: Exactly when in 2027 will the new routes arrive?

Why it matters

The update shows how game makers can respond to what fans want after a game comes out, adding stories that were cut before release.

Test what you remember

1. **Which companies announced the expansion pass?**
   - (A) Sony and Microsoft
   - (B) Polygon and Billboard
   - (C) Sega and Capcom
   - (D) Nintendo and Intelligent Systems
2. **When did Fire Emblem: Fortune's Weave come out?**
   - (A) Sometime in 2027
   - (B) January 2020
   - (C) September 2026
   - (D) The 2026 holiday season
3. **What does the first wave add?**
   - (A) A new console
   - (B) Four new story routes
   - (C) New outfits
   - (D) Four new weapons
4. **Which older game inspired the new weapons?**
   - (A) Pokemon
   - (B) Fire Emblem Heroes
   - (C) Super Mario Bros.
   - (D) Fire Emblem: Three Houses
5. **When is the third wave expected?**
   - (A) In 2030
   - (B) In 2027
   - (C) Next week
   - (D) Already out
6. **Why did the team cut the game from eight main characters to four?**
   - (A) The game ran out of colors
   - (B) The characters were too scary
   - (C) Eight seemed too ambitious
   - (D) Fans asked for fewer characters

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: D 2: C 3: D 4: D 5: B 6: C

Questions to think about

1. **Fans: Many fans have been asking for the cut routes to return since the game came out.**

2. **Polygon: The website suggests fan requests may have played a part but thinks the routes were likely already being made and needed more time.**

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):